



Punch, or The London Charivari, was a British satirical magazine founded in 1841 in London. It was inspired by a French newspaper and the puppet character Punch. The magazine used humour to make fun of politics, society, and people's behaviour. Although it was meant to be funny, its creators also wanted it to educate readers and encourage moral thinking.

During the 19th century, Punch became very popular and influential. It used articles and cartoons to criticise social problems and unfair practices, such as capital punishment. The magazine did more than report events — it helped shape public opinion and became an important part of British cultural life.

In the 20th century, Punch became more conservative and slowly lost readers. Changes in style and internal problems damaged its reputation, and it finally closed in 2002 after a failed attempt to revive it. Even today, Punch is remembered for its influence on humour and political cartoons.



*"Gentlemen, the cartoon !"* at the Mahagony table in Punch's Fleet Street office.